

Tinotenda Madzunguruse

Wine Waiter & Hospitality Professional

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PROFILE

Dedicated sommelier and hospitality professional with 6+ years of front-of-house experience across luxury cruise hospitality, premium Cape Winelands tasting rooms, and fine dining. Skilled in wine list curation, cellar management, staff wine education, food and wine pairing, beverage upselling, and guest storytelling. Deep knowledge of South African wine particularly Western Cape, Swartland, and Cape Winelands regions with hands-on experience working directly with boutique and lesser-known producers. Proficient in Lightspeed, Eazywine, Micros, Microsoft Suite, and Google Suite.

CORE COMPETENCIES

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| ✓ Premium Table & Wine Service | ✓ Food & Wine Pairing | ✓ Beverage Upselling & Sales |
| ✓ Guest Education & Storytelling | ✓ Tasting Room Operations | ✓ Inventory & Stock Control |
| ✓ Team Support & Mentorship | ✓ Staff Training & Daily Briefings | ✓ POS & Wine Management Systems |

WORK EXPERIENCE

Sommelier (Part-Time) · *Pigalle Restaurant, Green Point* Mar 2026 – Present

- Led premium wine upselling during dining service across a 350-seat fine-dining floor, using guest-tailored recommendations to drive beverage revenue.
- Drove a wine list and menu revamp aligned to a modern clientele, restructuring the offering to better reflect contemporary guest preferences and improve average beverage spend.
- Supported the bar team with cocktail preparation during peak after-dinner service, extending beverage coverage beyond wine into spirits and mixology.
- Navigated an extensive wine list under high-volume restaurant pace at one of Cape Town's largest and most awarded dining venues.

Sommelier · *Cunard Cruiseline — Queen Victoria* Jul 2025 – Feb 2026

- Delivered premium wine and beverage service across luxury dining venues and bars, upholding Cunard guest experience standards throughout every service period.
- Drove beverage revenue through confident, consultative upselling of wines, spirits, cocktails, digestifs, and drinks packages aligned to daily targets.
- Assisted in promoting and selling Cunard Wine Academy experiences including Lunch & Learn sessions, curated tastings, and gourmet pairing dinners.
- Covered full daily service across breakfast, lunch, and dinner sittings including hot beverage and bar service during peak periods.
- Managed dispense bar stock control: maintained inventory accuracy, coordinated replenishment via onboard stores, and ensured correct stock rotation.

Tasting Room Assistant · *Bartinney Private Cellar* Aug 2024 – Jun 2025

- Hosted structured wine tastings and cellar tours, translating terroir, winemaking style, and sustainability into clear and engaging guest storytelling.
- Increased direct sales through preference-based wine recommendations, driving bottle sales and wine club sign-ups.
- Delivered private experiences including cellar tours, pairing dinners, and group tastings, coordinating logistics and service execution.
- Supported tasting room performance by coaching junior staff on product knowledge, service standards, and upselling.
- Maintained operational readiness across stock levels, glassware standards, and tasting room and cellar presentation.

Sommelier · *MERTIA* Dec 2023 – Jul 2024

- Provided attentive front-of-house service during tastings and dining, ensuring guests received accurate wine guidance and food pairing recommendations.
- Curated and actively managed the wine list, sourcing from boutique and lesser-known producers across the Western Cape with a particular focus on Swartland winemakers to create a list that reflected regional authenticity and drove guest discovery.
- Implemented beverage inventory controls and strengthened stock management procedures across service periods.
- Enhanced the wine list offering and delivered high-impact food and wine pairing guidance to elevate guest experience and drive sales.
- Supported staff wine education initiatives to improve product knowledge, recommendation confidence, and service consistency across the team.

Tasting Room Assistant · *Muratie Wine Estate* Dec 2019 – Jul 2023

- Delivered warm, knowledgeable wine service in a high-traffic estate tasting room, consistently achieving strong guest satisfaction and repeat visitor rates.
- Drove a 25% increase in wine club sign-ups and improved the buying rate ratio per visitor through preference-led recommendations and genuine guest engagement.
- Applied strategic upselling and cross-selling techniques to maximise the value of each customer transaction across the wine portfolio.
- Used persuasive communication and deep product knowledge to guide guests through the estate's range, increasing both confidence in purchase decisions and average spend.

QUALIFICATIONS

IU Applied Science Bsc Business and IT · Dec 2024, Online
Cape Wine Academy Certificate in Wine · Oct 2021, Stellenbosch

WSET Level 2 Award in Wines · Oct 2021

WSET Level 3 Award in Wines · InProgress

SKILLS

Wine Knowledge Old & New World varietals, regions, tasting profiles, food pairing

Table Service Fine dining service standards, silver service, beverage service etiquette

Languages English (fluent)

Communication Confident guest communicator; experienced in wine education and storytelling